CHUNGMANN KIM

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DEVELOPMENT ECONOMIST | HUMANITARIAN RESEARCHER | DATA SCIENTIST

PROFILE

I am a development economist and humanitarian researcher working on food security, nutrition and humanitarian finance. My research asks who is counted as being in need and who is missed, whether aid reaches the places where needs are greatest, and whether it arrives in time. Much of my work looks at the evidence behind these decisions, the indicators, classifications and models that governments and agencies rely on, and evaluates how well it reflects conditions on the ground. I combine household surveys and administrative records with AI methods that turn unstructured data into measurable evidence to answer these questions.

CURRENT POSITION

- **Bloomberg School of Public Health, Johns Hopkins University** *Jan 2026 – Present*
  Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Center for Humanitarian Health Baltimore, MD
  - **Humanitarian finance:** subnational allocation of humanitarian aid relative to needs across crisis-affected countries
  - **Climate, conflict and displacement:** spatial econometric models for Iraq and Mali

EDUCATION

- **University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign** *2025*
  Ph.D. in Applied Economics (Agricultural and Consumer Economics)
- **Seoul National University** *2019*
  M.Sc. in Agricultural Technology Republic of Korea
- **Handong Global University** *2015*
  B.Sc. in Environmental Studies, cum laude Republic of Korea

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

"**Official Estimates of Global Food Insecurity Undercount Acute Hunger**." Lentz, E., Baylis, K., Michelson, H., & **Kim, C.** (2025). ***Nature Food*** 6(12): 1196–1208. *AAEA Quality of Research Discovery Award.* [Article] [Code]

"**Inside the Black Box: How Consistent Are Global Food Security Crisis Analyses?**" Lentz, E., Baylis, K., Michelson, H., & **Kim, C.** (2026). ***Food Policy*** 138: 103028. [Article] [Code]

"**Machine Learning for Food Security: Principles for Transparency and Usability**." Zhou, Y., Lentz, E., Michelson, H., **Kim, C.**, & Baylis, K. (2022). ***Applied Economic Perspectives and Policy*** 44(2): 893–910. [Article]

"**Exploring the Association between Agricultural Production Systems and Household Diets in Viet Nam**." Bandyopadhyay, A., Azzarri, C., Haile, B., **Kim, C.**, et al. (2022). ***Food Security*** 14(5): 1207–1226. [Article]

"**The Economics of the Soy Kit for Food Entrepreneurs**." **Kim, C.** & Goldsmith, P. (2021). ***Food and Nutrition Bulletin***. [Article]

WORKING PAPERS

"**Hearing the Alarm: Do Donors Follow Institutional Crisis Signals?**" [Draft]
How humanitarian funding responds when food-security emergencies are formally declared, using subnational aid data and a staggered difference-in-differences design.
Selected presentations and posters: UNU-WIDER 2025 · EAAE 2025 · AAEA 2025 · APHA 2026

"**Early-Year Milk Price and Child Stunting in Zambia**." With Baylis, K. [Draft] [Slides]
How food prices in the first years of life relate to child growth, linking household health surveys with local price data.
Selected presentations and posters: AAEA 2022 · EAAE 2023 · Tata-Cornell 2023 · APHA 2026

"**Multidimensional Food Security Indicators: Evidence from Sub-Saharan Africa**." With Baylis, K., Lentz, E., & Michelson, H.
How the choice of food-security indicator shapes who is identified as food insecure, and what that implies for targeting.
Selected presentations and posters: AAEA 2022

POLICY AND TECHNICAL WORK

IPC Accuracy Study (with Lentz, Baylis & Michelson), IPC report, 2024 [Report] · **LACI framework** for reviewing AI and statistical models, FAO with EC-JRC, 2025–2026 [GitHub] · **News-based early warning** prototype, FAO with Kickstart AI, 2025 [Note] · **Viet Nam diagnostic overview**, IFPRI, 2021 [Report]

Professional Experience

- **FAO, IPC Global Support Unit** *Feb 2024 – Present*
  Data Scientist and Modelling Specialist, consultant (part-time) Home-based
  ◦ Lead development of the LACI model-review framework; focal point for the EC-JRC collaboration; validated a news-based early-warning prototype (South Sudan)
- **International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD)** *Sep 2023 – Jan 2024*
  Impact Assessment Specialist, consultant (part-time) Home-based
  ◦ Harmonized multi-country impact-assessment data and automated the data pipelines
- **FAO, IPC Global Support Unit** *Oct 2022 – Aug 2023*
  Food Security Analyst, consultant (part-time) Home-based
  ◦ Led the empirical analysis of the IPC Accuracy Study, a global review of food-crisis classifications
- **International Food Policy Research Institute (IFPRI)** *Oct 2018 – Jan 2019*
  Research Intern Washington, DC
- **Canaan Farmer School** *2015 – 2017*
  Agricultural development project, Kilosa District (intern, then Project and Training Officer) Korea & Tanzania

Teaching, Talks and Honors

Teaching: ACE 251 The World Food Economy (Fall 2024; weekly lectures) · ACE 435 Global Agribusiness Management (TA, 2022, 2023), University of Illinois

Invited talks: Cornell CIDER Thought Summit (2026) · Johns Hopkins Food Assistance Strategic Dialogue (2026) · Stanford FSE seminar (2025) · UNU-WIDER (2025)

Honors: AAEA Quality of Research Discovery Award (2025) · Top-5 finalist, Johns Hopkins AI + Health Care Idea Tank (2026) · ACE Doctoral Fellowship (2025) · UNU-WIDER travel grant (2025)

Service: Referee, *Nature Food*, *BMC Public Health* · Member, IPC ATARI Working Group · Member, AAEA and EAAE

Methods and Tools

Econometrics: quasi-experimental methods (difference-in-differences, event studies, IV, RD, matching) · applied microeconometrics · spatial econometrics
Machine learning and AI: supervised learning (random forest, gradient boosting, LASSO) · NLP and LLM-based information extraction · model evaluation
Data: household surveys (LSMS-ISA, DHS) · administrative and funding records · geospatial data
Programming languages: Stata · R · Python · SQL
Platforms: Google Cloud · Google Earth Engine · QGIS · Git and GitHub
Languages: Korean (native) · English (fluent) · Chinese (intermediate)

References

Kathy Baylis
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University of Texas at Austin
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